Properties of non-metals

Non-metals have the opposite characteristics to metals. For example, metals are shiny but non-metals are dull. Non-metals:

- do not conduct heat and electricity very well
- are brittle (this means they may shatter if you hit them)
- are usually dull
- have low melting and boiling points
- are usually gases at room temperature
- are light for their size
- are softer and weaker than metals
- can be solids, but only bromine is a liquid at room temperature.

☞ **1** Use the notes above to write a paragraph in your workbook describing the properties of non-metals.

2 Unjumble the sentence parts and then rewrite each sentence in the correct order.

a to make Sulphur is used matches, fungicides and sulfuric acid.

b for bleach Chlorine is used and disinfectant.

c fertiliser used in Nitrogen is snap-freezing vegetables. and for

d prevent tooth decay. in toothpaste to Fluorine is used

e lighter than air, is used to fill balloons so when it Helium is they float.

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